Ford Motor Company

March 2001

TO: All Ford and Lincoln Mercury Dealers

SUBJECT: Safety Recall 01S07: All 1998-1999 and Certain 2000 Model Year Ranger-EV Transaxle Attaching Bolts Replacement

AFFECTED VEHICLES

All 1998-1999 and certain 2000 model year Ranger-EV vehicles built at the Edison Assembly Plant from October 27, 1997 through July 25, 2000.

SAFETY CONCERN

In some of the affected vehicles the transaxle attaching bolts may loosen and the vehicle may 'jerk' or 'clunk'. If the vehicle is not serviced promptly, and all of the attaching bolts fall out or fracture, it is possible that the vehicle may not be in the gear indicated by the gearshift indicator. If this occurs, the vehicle may be free to roll as if in neutral.

SERVICE ACTION

The dealer must replace all nine transaxle attachment bolts with longer bolts equipped with thread lock material. These bolts will be installed at a higher torque. This must be done on all of the affected vehicles.

PLEASE NOTE

Correct all vehicles in stock before delivery. Federal law requires dealers to complete any outstanding safety recall service before a new vehicle is delivered to the buyer or lessee. Violation of this requirement by a dealer could result in a civil penalty of up to $5,000 per vehicle.

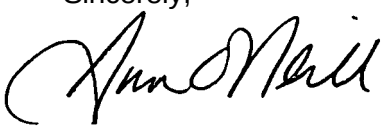
ATTACHMENTS

Attachment I: Administrative Information
Attachment II: Labor Allowances and Parts Ordering Information
Attachment III: Technical Information
Customer Notification Letter

QUESTIONS?

Claims Information:……..……...1-800-423-8851
Other (Dealer Only) Recall Questions:……..……...1-800-325-5621

Sincerely,



Ann O'Neill
Director
Vehicle Service and Programs

Safety Recall 01S07: All 1998-1999 and Certain 2000 Model Year Ranger-EV Transaxle Attaching Bolts Replacement

OASIS

You must use OASIS to determine if a vehicle is eligible for this recall.

PROMPTLY CORRECT

Promptly correct all affected vehicles on your dealer Recall/ONP Involved Unit Listings available on QCDealer.com. Also, correct other eligible vehicles which are brought to your dealership.

DEALER-OWNER CONTACT

Immediately contact any affected owner whose name is not on the list. Give the owner a copy of the Owner Letter and schedule a service date.

REGIONAL CONTACT

Advise regional office if an owner:

- cannot be contacted.
- does not make a service date.

CLAIMS PREPARATION AND SUBMISSION

- Enter claims using DWE.
- Refer to ACESII manual for claims preparation and submission information.

OWNER REFUNDS

Ford Motor Company will only refund owner-paid repairs made before the date of the Owner Letter (or after the date of the Owner Letter if an emergency repair was made away from the servicing dealer). Refer to ACESII manual for refund information.

TOWING / RENTAL CARS

In rare cases, complete loss of the transaxle attaching bolts may result in failure of the transaxle, which prevents the vehicle from being driven to the dealership for repairs. Under these circumstances, Ford Motor Company will pay for both the cost of towing and a rental vehicle, except for fuel which will be at owner's expense. Rental vehicles are authorized for a maximum of 5 days. Enter the word "RENTAL" plus the number of days the vehicle was used in the Miscellaneous Expense area. Follow ESP cost guidelines. For towing, enter the word "TOW" in the Miscellaneous Expense area of the claim form.

Safety Recall 01S07: All 1998-1999 and Certain 2000 Model Year Ranger-EV Transaxle Attaching Bolts Replacement

LABOR ALLOWANCES

Description	Labor Operation	Labor Time
Replace (9) Transaxle Attachment Bolts	01S07B	0.9 Hour
Administrative Allowance	Misc. Expense Code "ADMIN"	0.1 Hour

PARTS REQUIREMENTS

Parts Ordering Information

Parts will not be direct shipped for this recall. This program has been defined as a **Small Volume Program** and will require dealers/customers to call 1-800-248-0186 with an appropriate VIN to order parts. This will remain in effect for 90 days after launch of the campaign, after that, normal order processing will begin.

All Order Types	First 90 days after launch	Call 1-800-248-0186
All Order Types	After 90 days	Normal Process

Part Number	Description	Quantity
W708032-S426	Transaxle Attaching Bolts (PACKAGE OF 9)	1 package per vehicle

DOR/COR

DOR/COR Number 50220 identifies parts ordered for this campaign through the "Small Volume" Recall Hotline (1-800-248-0186).

DEALER PRICE

For latest prices, refer to:

- DOES II
- Updated Price Book

EXCESS STOCK RETURN

Excess stock returned for credit must have been purchased from Ford Customer Service Division in accordance with Policy Procedure Bulletin 4000.

Ford Motor Company

Ford Motor Company
P. O. Box 1904
Dearborn, Michigan 48121

March 2001

01S07

Mr. John Sample
123 Main Street
Anywhere, USA 12345

Your Vehicle Identification Number: 12345678901234567

This notice is sent to you in accordance with the requirements of the National Traffic and Motor Vehicle Safety Act.

Ford Motor Company has decided that a defect which relates to motor vehicle safety exists in all 1998-1999 and certain 2000 Ranger-EV vehicles.

What the safety issue is …	In some of the affected vehicles the transaxle attaching bolts may loosen and the vehicle may 'jerk' or 'clunk'. If the vehicle is not serviced promptly and all of the attaching bolts fall out or fracture, it is possible that the vehicle may not be in the gear indicated by the gearshift indicator. If this occurs, the vehicle may be free to roll as if in neutral.
What Ford Motor Company and your dealer will do ...	Ford Motor Company will repair your vehicle free of charge (parts and labor). Owners who are affected by this recall are requested to return their vehicle to their dealer for installation of nine revised transaxle attaching bolts.
How long will it take?	The time needed for this repair is less than one-half day. However, due to service scheduling issues, your dealer may need your vehicle for a longer period of time.

What we are asking you to do …

Call your dealer without delay. Ask for a service date and whether parts are in stock for Safety Recall 01S07.

If your dealer does not have the parts in stock, they can be ordered before scheduling your service date. Parts would be expected to arrive within a week after ordering.

When you bring your vehicle in, show the dealer this letter. If you misplace this letter, your dealer will still do the work, free of charge.

If you've already paid for this service …

If you paid to have this service done before the date of this letter, Ford is offering a full refund. For the refund, please give your paid original receipt to your dealer. To avoid delays, do not send receipts to Ford Motor Company.

If you've changed address or sold the vehicle …

Please fill out the enclosed prepaid postcard and mail it to us if you have changed address or sold the vehicle.

If you have concerns …

If you have trouble getting your vehicle repaired promptly and without charge, please contact your dealership's Service Manager. If you still need assistance, please contact the Ford Motor Company Customer Relationship Center and one of our representatives will be happy to assist you:

CALL: (800) 392-3673
(800) 232-5952 (TDD for the Hearing Impaired)

Office Hours: (Eastern Standard Time)

Monday-Friday: 8am - 11pm
Saturday: 9am - 6pm

or you may contact us through the Internet at:
www.ownerconnection.com
Our current response time to Internet inquiries is three business days.

You also may send a complaint to the Administrator, National Highway Traffic Safety Administration, 400 Seventh Street, S. W., Washington, D. C. 20590 or call the toll free Auto Safety Hotline 1-888-327-4236 or 1-800-424-9393.

Quality Care service is there for you all year round.

Quality Care is the commitment of Ford Motor Company and its dealerships to provide you with a superior service and ownership experience. While we regret the inconvenience caused by this program, we stand committed with our dealers to assist you with all of your automotive service needs. With our nationwide dealer network, we're here to ensure you receive Quality Care service so that your vehicle maintains peak performance throughout your ownership experience.

We pride ourselves on becoming the world's leading consumer company for automotive products and services. Thank you for your attention to this important matter.

Sincerely,

Ann O'Neill
Director
Vehicle Service and Programs